

The Minimalist Developer's Manifesto

Principles for Clean Code

1. Simplicity Over Complexity

We believe that the simplest solution is often the best. Complexity should be earned, not assumed.

2. Readability First

Code is read far more often than it is written. Write for your future self and your teammates.

3. Small Functions, Clear Intent

Each function should do one thing well. If you can't name it clearly, it's doing too much.

4. Test-Driven Clarity

Tests are documentation. If you can't test it easily, the design needs work.

5. Refactor Fearlessly

Code is a living thing. Refactor early, refactor often. Technical debt compounds.

6. YAGNI (You Aren't Gonna Need It)

Don't build for hypothetical futures. Build for today's needs, design for tomorrow's changes.

7. Fail Fast, Fail Clearly

Errors should be obvious and immediate. Silent failures are the enemy.

8. Version Control is Your Time Machine

Commit often, commit clearly. Your git history is your project's memory.

9. Documentation Lives in Code

Comments explain why, code explains what. If you need comments to explain what, refactor.

10. Tools Serve Developers

Automation should reduce cognitive load, not increase it. If a tool makes you think harder, question it.

The Path Forward

Embrace simplicity. Write clearly. Test thoroughly. Refactor continuously.

The best code is code that doesn't need to exist.